

STAGE TWO • PROFESSIONAL IDENTITY & PERSONAL BRAND

FIRSTS

DISCUSSION PROMPTS

Open-ended questions to seed group conversation beyond the worksheets

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Discussion Prompts

Stage Two • Professional Identity & Personal Brand

PURPOSE

Individual worksheets answer “what did you write for your brand statement / headline / bio?” These prompts answer a different question: “what's your real, lived experience of building or navigating a professional brand?” They're open-ended and personal, meant to seed conversation beyond a simple share-out of worksheet answers.

Use these during share-out portions, when a session finishes its planned agenda with time to spare, or when a group's energy needs a genuine, specific prompt rather than “any volunteers?” They're organized by session (matching this stage's six sections), four prompts each.

As with every stage, these are meant to be read aloud and picked selectively — choose the one or two that feel most alive for the room rather than working through all four every time.

Prompts by Session

SESSION 1

Personal Professional Identity

"Have you ever met someone whose elevator pitch was so clear you still remember it? What made it work?"

"What's a professional communication style you've admired in someone else but haven't tried yourself?"

"Where does professional confidence genuinely come from — is it something you build, or something you fake until it's real?"

"Has your personal value statement changed at all since you started this program? What shifted it?"

SESSION 2

Personal Brand Foundations

"What's a brand positioning choice you've seen someone else make that genuinely worked — niching down instead of trying to appeal to everyone?"

"Has anyone ever given you reputation feedback that surprised you, good or bad?"

"What's a professional boundary you've had to set that felt uncomfortable in the moment but was genuinely right?"

"Looking at your own image audit, what's one thing you'd change immediately, and one thing you'd leave alone?"

SESSION 3

Digital Presence & Online Identity

"What's the gap between your actual digital footprint and the one you'd want a recruiter to see?"

"Has a LinkedIn headline (yours or someone else's) ever actually gotten you a real opportunity or conversation?"

"If you could redesign your online presence from scratch with no history to clean up, what would you genuinely do differently?"

"What's holding you back from building a personal website or portfolio, if you don't have one yet?"

SESSION 4

Professional Communication

"What's an email opener or sign-off that instantly makes you take a message more (or less) seriously?"

"Describe a meeting where you felt genuinely present and engaged versus one where you checked out. What was actually different?"

"What's a question you've asked in a professional setting that you're genuinely proud of?"

"How did it feel watching your own video introduction back? Be honest."

SESSION 5

Professional Visibility

"What's stopped you from posting or sharing content professionally, even when you had something genuinely worth saying?"

"Have you ever engaged with someone else's post in a way that led to a real professional connection?"

"What's a topic you could genuinely speak on as a thought leader, even in a small way, right now?"

"What's the difference between being visible and being genuinely valuable to your professional network?"

SESSION 6

Professional Materials

"What's the most honest feedback you've ever gotten on your resume or cover letter?"

"Has a specific project or piece of work in your portfolio ever surprised someone who reviewed it?"

"Looking at your full digital presence plan, what's the one piece you're most behind on, and why do you think that is?"

"What does 'done' actually look like for your professional materials — or is this genuinely a living, ongoing project?"